

Your master's search — the complete guide

Everything gathered across five separate searches, in one document. Sound design · music production · audio engineering · music technology · music business. Target intake: **September 2027**.

What you're holding

1,029 unique opportunities across 56 countries — master's programmes at public and private institutions, plus every scholarship scheme attached to them. Merged and de-duplicated from five searches that ran over several weeks:

Search	Found	What it covered
Worldwide sweep	539	Every region, every funding scheme, all five subject tracks
Deep Europe	102	Follow-up on every European country individually
Sound design deep dive	319	Conservatoires, film schools, private academies across Europe
Private ES/PT/NL/IT	114	Private institutions in four countries, with accreditation checked
Europe gap sweep	85	Everything the first four missed, public and private

Everything was searched **in English and in the local language** — *Tontechnik*, *conception sonore*, *realizacja dźwięku*, *musica elettronica*, *hangmérnök*, *ses tasarımı* — because English-only searching misses most of this field.

The companion spreadsheet is **MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx**. This document explains what's in it and what it means. The spreadsheet is where you filter and decide.

Your profile, which every judgement here is based on

- Tunisian national — **you need a student visa for everywhere in this document**. This constraint does more work than any other
- BSc Software Engineering, SMU MedTech, graduating now
- **No music degree. No conservatoire training. No professional audio experience**. No portfolio yet
- **Arabic native, French fluent, English working. IELTS/TOEFL not yet taken**
- Goal: international DJ and music producer
- Funding: fully funded strongly preferred; partial fine; self-pay only if genuinely cheap

How to read "chance of acceptance"

Every row carries a **Chance for you** column with three values, plus a **Why** column giving the actual reason. This is the column that does most of the work, so it matters that you understand exactly what it is — and what it isn't.

	Meaning	What triggers it
Strong	The published entry rules name your background, or accept any bachelor's	<i>"any bachelor's degree", "computer science", "engineering", "telecomunicaciones o informática"</i>
Possible	Plausible, but something needs asking or arguing	<i>"or related field", "or equivalent",</i> hedged wording like <i>"may qualify — confirm with us"</i> , or silence on the question
Weak	Something you don't have is required	A music degree, a live audition, professional audio experience, or a teaching language you don't speak

What this is not. It is computed from the entry text each institution publishes — not from an admissions officer, not from acceptance statistics, and not from your actual application. It is a filter to save you weeks of reading, not a prediction. **Always read the "Entry requirements" and "Why that chance" columns before ruling something in or out.**

How it was checked. I validated it against a dozen programmes whose answers I already knew, and it caught real errors in my own logic:

- *Conservatorium van Amsterdam, Immersive Audio* was scoring **Strong** because the word "software" appeared in the record. Its actual entry text demands *"a bachelor's degree in Music" and "significant experience in audio engineering at a professional level."* Now **Weak**
- *HfM Detmold Musikregie* was scoring Strong; it is a top-up on an existing **Tonmeister** bachelor. Now **Weak** — while Detmold's *M.Sc. Music Acoustics*, which does list Physics and Acoustics as comparable, correctly sits at **Possible**
- Programmes taught in a language you don't speak are **downgraded even when the entry rules are wide open** — Ankara accepts literally any bachelor's, but it teaches in Turkish, so it is Possible rather than Strong

Across 1,029 records: **401 Strong · 419 Possible · 209 Weak.**

The three questions that actually decide this

Everything in the spreadsheet reduces to these, in this order:

1. Can you get in? the *Chance* column

Your binding constraint isn't grades — it's that you have **no music degree and no portfolio yet**. That single fact eliminates most conservatoire programmes in Europe and makes engineering-facing programmes disproportionately valuable to you.

2. Can you afford it? the *Cost band* column

This is what **you** pay as a non-EU national, which is frequently *not* the headline rate.

Band	Count	Reality
Free	98	Mostly German public universities and fully-funded schemes
Under €1,500/yr	94	Italian conservatoires with ISEEE, Turkish public, Greek public

Band	Count	Reality
€1,500–5,000/yr	138	French public (€3,950 flat), Georgian, Iberian public
€5,000–15,000/yr	209	Portuguese private, Irish, some Nordic
Over €15,000/yr	201	All UK, Berklee, Aalto, Dutch private, Norway
Not published	289	The institution publishes nothing — ask them

3. Can you follow the teaching? the *Taught in* column

This is the gate people underestimate, and it's where your profile is unusual. You are fluent in French. That is worth more here than the IELTS you haven't taken, because it opens the entire French public system at €3,950/year — programmes you could follow from day one, with no preparation year.

Where I would actually apply

114 opportunities are both Strong and cheap-or-free. These are the ones worth your attention. Grouped by what kind of bet each one is:

The lowest-risk applications — no portfolio, no audition, free

These are decided on your **transcript**, not on a portfolio you don't have yet. That makes them the safest thing you can apply to in this entire document.

Programme	Where	Language	Cost
TU Ilmenau — M.Sc. Medieningenieurwissenschaften	Ilmenau	English or German	Free + ~€332/sem
TU Berlin — Audio Communication and Technology	Berlin	English + German	Free
FAU Erlangen-Nürnberg — Communications & Multimedia Eng.	Erlangen	English	Free
TU Ilmenau — Research in Media Engineering	Ilmenau	English + German	Free
Politecnico di Milano — Music and Acoustic Engineering	Milan	English	~€4,000/yr

TU Ilmenau is the single best structural fit found anywhere. Verified: completable **entirely in English**, **NC-frei** (no competitive ranking), **no portfolio, no audition, no entrance exam**, and **Fraunhofer IDMT — the institute that invented mp3 and AAC — is on the same campus.** It will not make you a DJ; it makes you employable in audio technology and buys you years in Germany to build the production career alongside it. Apply **16 Jan – 15 May 2027** via uni-assist. You **do** need English at C1 (~IELTS 7.0), and the application fee is €75.

Fully funded, and open to you

Scheme	Where	Why it fits
DIGICREA (Erasmus Mundus)		Zero tuition for everyone , scholarship or not, + €1,400/month. Sound-Music entry track

Scheme	Where	Why it fits
ReSound (Erasmus Mundus)		Officially accepts computational science degrees. Portfolio: 3 works, 10–15 min
Stipendium Hungaricum		~30 public universities, 900+ programmes, English-taught, full ride
Türkiye Bursları		Tuition + stipend + housing + insurance + flights

Cheap, accredited, and in a language you already speak

Programme	Where	Cost	Note
CNSMD Lyon — Musique Son Image	Lyon	Free	Public conservatoire, French
Université de Strasbourg — <i>Création-Production musiques actuelles</i>		€3,950/yr	French
Université Lyon 2 — <i>Musiques Appliquées aux Arts Visuels</i>		€3,950/yr	French
École Centrale de Lyon + INSA — MSc Acoustics	Lyon	€3,770/yr	English
Cnam Angoulême — <i>Conception sonore</i>		€3,950/yr	French

France is 34 of the 114 best bets — by far the largest single block, precisely because your French removes the language gate that blocks most applicants.

Best value if you'll learn a language

Programme	Where	Cost	Language
Conservatorio G.B. Martini — Musica Elettronica, Sound Design	Bologna	~€166/yr with ISEEE	Italian
Saint Louis College of Music — Sound Design & Post Produzione	Rome	€14,460–17,000 <i>total</i>	Italian + English
Ankara Müzik ve Güzel Sanatlar — Müzik Teknolojileri		~€390/yr , or free	Turkish
Tbilisi State Conservatoire — MA Music Technology		€3,423/yr	English
Universidade Lusófona — Produção e Tecnologias do Som	Lisbon	€7,600–9,130 <i>total</i>	Portuguese
UCP Porto — Som e Imagem, Design de Som	Porto	€13,140 <i>total</i>	Portuguese

Italy's conservatoires are **income-scaled**: filing an **ISEEE** declaration takes Bologna from €2,166/year to about **€166**. That single piece of paperwork is worth roughly €4,000 over the degree.

Public vs private — and the trap that runs through it

647 public · 277 private · 105 unclear.

Public almost always means cheaper *and* accredited by default. Private is where the money and the risk both live — because **in every country surveyed, a private school may legally sell you something called a "Master" that is not a master's degree.**

Country	A real degree	What gets sold instead
Spain	Máster Universitario Oficial (ANECA, in RUCT)	Título propio / Máster de Formación Permanente
Italy	Laurea magistrale / Diploma Accademico di II livello	"Master" di I livello (60 CFU)
Portugal	Mestrado (A3ES-accredited)	Pós-graduação, curso técnico
Netherlands	NVAO-accredited MA/MSc	CRKBO "diploma", NRTO certificate
Germany	State-accredited M.A./M.Sc.	— (the private audio sector is marginal here)

The clearest example found: *Pro Audio Education NL* sells a diploma titled **"Master Geluidstechniek"** for €5,695. It is not NVAO-accredited, carries no ECTS, and the school itself places the training at **MBO+/HBO– level — below the bachelor you already hold.**

Two findings about private education worth keeping

The Netherlands is structurally closed. There is **no private NVAO-accredited master in this field anywhere in the country**, and **no private Dutch audio school is an IND recognised sponsor** — so none can host your residence permit. Abbey Road Institute Amsterdam charges €18,860–€20,160 for a non-degree; SAE up to €37,580 for a *bachelor*. Don't build a plan there.

But "not official" does not automatically mean "no visa" — I got this wrong initially and the verification pass corrected me. Under Spain's RD 1155/2024 and the June 2025 management criteria, **both títulos oficiales and títulos propios are admissible** for a study permit. What actually decides it is **study intensity: 91+ days, 90% of credits, and 20 contact hours per week** (or 12 in person for concentrated programmes).

So there are **two separate tests** and you need both:

Test	Decides	Fails it
Accreditation	Whether it's a real degree — PhD access, recognition at home	título propio, CRKBO diploma, Master di I livello
Contact hours	The visa	Evening courses, part-time, hybrid, online

This is why UFV Madrid's €6,100 evening certificate (10 hours/week) is legally unusable, and why UCAM Murcia — extraordinary value at **€4,194 all-in**, with your degree named in its entry profile — is rated only **C**: it's hybrid, and that's a real visa risk. Get it in writing before paying.

Money — the country-level picture

The single most useful financial fact in this entire search:

Most German states charge non-EU students no tuition at all. Not a discount — nothing. You pay the same semester contribution (~€330) as a German student. Confirmed for Thuringia, NRW, Bavaria, Bremen, Lower Saxony, Saarland, Rhineland-Palatinate and Saxony.

Country	What you'd pay per year	Note
Germany	€0 + ~€330/semester	Across most Länder
Hungary / Turkey (funded)	€0	Via Stipendium Hungaricum / Türkiye Bursları
Italy public	€166–3,500	Income-scaled — file the ISEE
Turkey (self-pay)	~€390	Ankara MGÜ
Greece	€700/sem – €3,750 total	No non-EU differential at all
France	€3,950 flat	Public universities, all levels
Georgia	€3,423	Tbilisi Conservatoire
Portugal	€3,800–6,570	Private universities, no non-EU surcharge
Spain	€4,900–13,000	Public conservatoires vary widely by region
Ireland	€13,500	MTU
Finland	€10,000–20,000	Except Uniarts Helsinki, which is free
UK	£16,280–£23,000	Uniformly expensive, no usable scholarship found
Norway	~€34,500	Non-EEA fees introduced 2023 — the "free Norway" reputation is out of date
Berklee Valencia	~\$67,000–71,000 all-in	Real and visa-safe, but 15× UCAM

Living costs on top, per month: Porto/Murcia ~€700–900 · Rome/Athens/Lisbon ~€900–1,300 · Ilmenau low · Barcelona/Valencia ~€900–1,000 · Milan €1,100–1,400 · Amsterdam €1,150–1,500.

Language — the gate you can actually move

Language	Programmes	Your position
English	~390 Strong-chance rows	Working level. You still need IELTS — Ilmenau wants C1 (~7.0), NABA only 5.0
French	34 of the 114 best bets	Fluent. This is your unfair advantage and it is under-used
German	Large, mostly free	A1 suffices at HfM Mainz; C1 at TH Köln
Italian	Cheapest accredited degrees	Would need ~a year

Language	Programmes	Your position
Portuguese	Best-value private mestrados	Would need ~a year; your French makes it reachable
Turkish / Greek	Cheapest of all	A year minimum, and the Ankara entrance exam is in Turkish

Two things worth acting on now:

1. **Ask SMU for a medium-of-instruction letter.** HfK Bremen waives its IELTS 7.0 requirement entirely if your qualifying degree was taught in English, with proof. Tbilisi accepts "*any official document confirming B2*", not only a test. That letter costs nothing and may save you the exam at several institutions.
2. **If you're going to learn a language, decide now.** Italian opens Bologna at €166/year; Portuguese opens UCP Porto and Lusófona. Either needs to start this year, not next spring.

Scholarships — what exists and what you can realistically win

335 records carry a named funding scheme; 308 distinct schemes in total. They are always attached to a programme rather than standing alone, which is why the spreadsheet has a **Scholarship index** tab: one row per scheme, showing how many programmes it covers and the best chance it offers.

The ones that matter for a Tunisian applicant with your profile:

Scheme	Covers	What it pays	Your chance
Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters	13+ programmes across AT, DK, FI, FR, IE, PT, ES, LT, UK	Full tuition + ~€1,400/month	Strong — DIGICREA and ReSound both fit you
Stipendium Hungaricum	~30 Hungarian universities, 900+ programmes	Full ride, English-taught	Strong
Türkiye Bursları	Turkish public universities	Tuition, stipend, housing, insurance, flights	Strong — deadline 20 February
DAAD Study Scholarship	German art/music schools	Monthly stipend (tuition already free)	Strong
Global Korea Scholarship	Korean universities	Full	Strong
Swedish Institute (SISGP)	Swedish universities	Full	Strong
IsDB Scholarship	Multiple countries	Full — and Tunisia is a member state	Strong
Fulbright Tunisia	USA	Full	Possible
Chevening	UK	Full	Possible — requires work experience

Scheme	Covers	What it pays	Your chance
Swiss Government Excellence	Switzerland	Full	Possible — art scholarships need a portfolio
Aalto Scholarship	Finland	Tuition waiver	Possible
NL Scholarship	Netherlands	€5,000 one-off	Possible

The honest summary on funding: the fully-funded routes that genuinely fit a non-music engineering graduate are **Erasmus Mundus (DIGICREA, ReSound)**, **Stipendium Hungaricum**, **Türkiye Bursları** and **DAAD**. Everything else either wants a portfolio you're still building, work experience you don't have, or is a partial discount rather than funding.

By region

Region	Opportunities	Character
Western Europe	314	France cheap and open to you; UK uniformly expensive; NL private closed
Southern Europe	231	Italy's public conservatoires are the cheapest real degrees in Europe
Central Europe	216	Germany free ; Austria/Switzerland strong but pricier; Poland/Czechia cheap
Nordics & Baltics	120	Split — Uniarts Helsinki free, Bergen ~€34,500. Baltics cheap and under-explored
Balkans & Türkiye	56	Cheapest of all; Ankara is the most open door found anywhere
North America	44	Expensive; Fulbright is the only realistic route
Asia-Pacific	35	GKS and Schwarzman are fully funded and genuinely open
Eastern Europe & Caucasus	3	Tbilisi is a real find; Ukraine recorded but not advisable

Your calendar

When	What
Now early 2027	Build the portfolio. Target the best spec found: 4–8 finished tracks, different roles (producer, engineer, writer), your role stated per track (Abbey Road's standard). This is the binding constraint on everything portfolio-based
Now	Ask SMU for a medium-of-instruction letter . Decide your second language and start it

When	What
Now	If Italy is in play, start the Dichiarazione di Valore or CIMEA statement — it's slow and it blocks applications, not just visas
~Sept–Dec 2026	Sit IELTS. Ilmenau needs ~7.0; NABA accepts 5.0; several ask for nothing
1 Nov 2026	Berklee Valencia Early Action (scholarship 15 Nov)
Nov 2026	DIGICREA call opens
1 Jan 2027	Saint Louis Rome opens for international applicants (test online Jan–Jun)
15 Jan 2027	Berklee Regular Action
1 Feb – 1 Apr 2027	HfM Mainz <i>Eignungsprüfung</i> registration
~Feb 2027	UCP Porto Phase 1 opens
20 Feb 2027	Türkiye Bursları closes
1 Apr – 31 May 2027	HfK Bremen applications
9 Apr 2027	UCP Porto Phase 1 closes
~Apr 2027	Italian conservatoire deadlines cluster here — and you get only 10 days to enrol after results
30 Apr 2027	Saint Louis Rome hard deadline for international applicants
15 May 2027	TU Ilmenau deadline (window opens 16 Jan)
31 May 2027	HMT München
~Late May 2027	NABA scholarship competition
Aug 2027	Ankara MGÜ (university deadline; the scholarship closed in February)

April–May 2027 is the real crunch, not September. Work backwards from there.

What I'd do in the next month

1. **Email TU Ilmenau** (info.apply@tu-ilmenau.de) — confirm the English-track language certificate, and whether your SMU transcript carries enough signal-processing and EE credits for the departmental review. This is the strongest option in the document and both questions are one email.
2. **Ask SMU for a medium-of-instruction letter**. Free, and it may remove the IELTS gate at Bremen, Tbilisi and others.
3. **Start the portfolio**. Four to eight finished tracks. Everything else waits on this.
4. **Pick your second language** — French is already yours, so the question is whether to add German, Italian or Portuguese. German unlocks the most free programmes; Italian unlocks the cheapest

accredited degree; Portuguese unlocks the best-value private mestrados.

5. **Register interest in DIGICREA and ReSound** ahead of the November 2026 calls. Both are fully funded, both accept computational-science backgrounds, and they are the best funding-to-fit ratio available to you.

Honesty and limits

- **Verification status.** Every record was sourced to an official page. A subset was then re-checked against that page by a second agent and carries a verdict and rating — that pass is still running at the time of writing and has covered the German batch and part of Spain. Where verification ran, it changed real things: it corrected TU Ilmenau's language requirement from "possibly none" to a firm C1, its application fee from €25 to €75, and it overturned my claim that an unofficial Spanish award blocks a student visa. **Treat unverified figures as good starting points to confirm, not settled facts.**
 - **Blank cells mean the institution publishes nothing.** No figure here was estimated to fill a gap. Where I give a range, it's derived from published per-month or per-instalment figures and labelled as derived.
 - **Dates marked PRIOR CYCLE are last year's**, kept because these calendars repeat closely. Confirm each when the 2027/28 cycle opens.
 - **Living costs are my own country-level estimates**, not research findings. Treat them as ballpark comparisons, not a budget.
 - **The "Chance" column is a filter, not a prediction.** It reads published entry text. It cannot know how an admissions panel will read your portfolio.
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The files

File	What it is
MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx	Everything — 1,029 rows, filterable. Start here. Tabs: Best Bets · Strong + English/French · Fully funded · Has a scholarship · Scholarship index · Free or cheap · Everything · one per region
MASTER-all-opportunities.csv	Same data, plain CSV
THE-COMPLETE-GUIDE.md / .pdf	This document
EUROPE-GAPFILL.md / .pdf + .xlsx	The 85 institutions the earlier searches missed
PRIVATE-SCHOOLS.md / .pdf + .xlsx	Private institutions in ES/PT/NL/IT, accreditation-first
SOUND-DESIGN-EUROPE.md + .xlsx	The 319-programme sound-design deep dive
SHORTLIST.md , ACTION-TIMELINE.md , PATHS-DEEP-DIVE.md	The earlier shortlist, timeline and the three-paths explainer

File	What it is
COULD-NOT-VERIFY.md	Everything I could not confirm, listed honestly